

Medford Public Schools



FY27 Preliminary Annual Budget Presentation

Committee of the Whole #2

May 12, 2026

Presented By: Noel Velez, Director of Finance and Gerry McCue,
Budget Analyst

FY2027 Preliminary Budget Recommendation



- Preliminary Budget Proposal on 4/6/2026: **\$94,032,696**
- Preliminary Budget Recommendation 5/12/2026: **\$90,683,398**

Guidance on Reducing Budget Proposal



Minimize Direct Impacts on Students

- Fully fund collective bargaining agreements
- Align with available funding
- Ground decision-making in MPS Core Values
- Use best efforts to avoid layoffs
- Comply with special education and English Learner staffing and spending requirements
- Manage class sizes
- Ensure immediate capital needs are met and address maintenance issues identified in the Facilities Conditions Assessment
- Increase professional development experiences, targeted to specific program needs to improve instructional practice and curriculum delivery
- Provide funds to transition to more rigorous instructional materials, align with DESE's strategic goal of providing students with a defined set of high-quality instructional materials



FY27 Preliminary Budget Recommendation Increase Compared to 4/6/26 Budget Proposal

Date of Budget Presentations	4/6/2026	5/12/2026
Current and estimated salary and step increases, stipend increases, contingency	\$3,347,551	\$2,784,300
Unavoidable/unsustainable cost increases	\$3,059,160	\$1,909,349
Requested new/increased school-based spending	\$987,172	\$360,236
Requested new/increased facilities and operations spending	\$554,255	\$109,255
Identified savings	(\$490,991)	(\$1,066,491)
Overall base budget increases	\$7,457,147	\$4,096,649
Net Reduction 4/6 to 5/12		(\$3,360,498)



FY27 Preliminary Budget Recommendation

Explainer of \$3,360,498 Net Reduction



Explainer of Net Reduction

Defer proposals to FY2028	(\$769,568)
Identify alternative sources of revenue	(\$1,500,677)
Reduce requested new/increased spending proposals	(\$593,999)
Staffing reductions	(\$496,254)
Total Base Budget Changes	(\$3,360,498)



Explainer of Net Reduction

Defer proposals to FY2028:	(\$769,568)
Transition paras remaining on B&A revolving fund to general fund	
Re-allocation of CS/Athletic Director and staff salaries	
Keep the Technology and Networking Director vacant for FY2027	
Defer increase to substitute teacher line	
Defer a portion of the increase in contracted maintenance	



Explainer of Net Reduction

Identifying Alternative Sources of Revenue	(\$1,500,677)
Charge special education transportation increase to Circuit Breaker	
Remove capital/maintenance projects in favor of a free cash proposal	
Charge homeless transportation expenses to the homeless transportation reimbursement account	
Charge vocational transportation to the Vocational Tuition revolving fund	
Funding for middle school robotics curriculum is now state grant funded	
Shift General Fund portion of City Year program to available grants	



Identifying Alternative Sources of Revenue - Free Cash Request

Roberts hot water tank replacement	\$250,000
Extraordinary maintenance funding to address Facilities Conditions Assessment projects	\$75,000
Interactive panels for classrooms	\$180,000
Defibrillator (AEDs) replacement	\$25,500
Total Free Cash Request	\$530,500



Explainer of Net Reduction

Reduce New/Increased Spending Requests	(\$593,999)
Yellow bus added in FY26 not funded in FY27 due to low ridership	
Reduce proposals for new PD and Supplies spending by about 1/3	
Hold added Art and Computer teachers at the high school, address in the Final budget, including \$25k for a 3 rd computer lab	
Cash in a vacant custodian at the high school in favor of adding a 4 th maintenance position, minimum staffing for custodians is maintained	
New EL teacher for middle school pull-out not funded, staffing can be re-organized to provide this position	



Explainer of Net Reduction

Staffing Reductions	(\$496,254)
Reduce one K teacher and para and one G4 teacher at the Roberts, and one G4 teacher at the Brooks to manage class size	
Reduce one kindergarten at the Missituk, teacher will move to G1 to add a G1 classroom, para not funded	
Staff reductions will be achieved through retirements or transfers to vacant positions	
Vacant Inclusion Specialist not funded	
Vacant Student Support Assistant not funded	



Average General Education Grade K-5 Class Size with Proposed Staffing Reductions

Brooks	19.8
McGlynn Elementary	17.6
Missituk	17.5
Roberts	18.8



Recap - FY27 Preliminary Budget Recommendation Increase Compared to 4/6/26 Budget Proposal

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FY27 Preliminary Budget Recommendation

Proposed Increase to Base Budget



Overall Proposed Increase to Base Budget

Fund current and estimated salary and step increases, including contingency	\$2,784,300
Spending related to required special education spending and operational increases due to contractual increases and inflation based on expense trends (required new spending):	\$1,909,349
School-Based New/Increased Spending	\$360,236
Facilities/Technology New/Increased Spending	\$109,255
Proposed New/Increased Base Budget Spending	\$5,163,140
Savings Identified on April 6 to Current Base Budget	(\$490,991)
Additional Reductions (Already Included in This Budget Recommendation)	(\$575,500)
Total Savings to Current Base Budget	(\$1,066,491)
Overall Proposed Base Budget Increase	\$4,096,649



Proposed New/Increased Spending to Base Budget

Fund Current and Estimated Salary and Step Increases, Including contingency	\$2,784,300
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Proposed New/Increased Spending to Base Budget

Required New Spending

(spending related to required special education spending and operational increases due to contractual increases and inflation based on expense trends):

\$1,909,349

Add two teachers at Curtis Tufts to the budget who are currently funded in a Shore Tuition revolving fund

Addition of eight 1:1 paraprofessionals required in existing IEPs for students new to the District in FY26

Creation of an Access program at MES, teacher & para

Creation of an Access program at MMS, teacher & para



Proposed New/Increased Spending to Base Budget

Required New Spending (continued)	
Add a second Project Transition teacher due to program enrollment at MHS	
Increase Extended Year programing for planned increase in student participation	
Special Education paras added (one each at MES, RES) for classroom coverage based on student/program needs	
Additional G1 teacher at the Missituk	
Fully fund the contract cleaning at the McGlynn Complex and the High School	
Heat and electricity increase	



Proposed New/Increased Spending to Base Budget

Required New Spending (continued)	
Custodial supplies increase	
Transition from VMware server to Hyper-V server for virtualization and cloud computing	
Add funding to the budget for our electronic health records software currently funded in our School Health grant	
Unemployment account increase	



Proposed New/Increased Spending to Base Budget

School-Based New/Increased Spending	\$360,236
Increase a 0.6 FTE elementary band teacher to 1.0 FTE to teach electives at MHS in periods 6&7	
Add one translator at the McGlynn to meet program needs	
Provide funds for middle school ELA curriculum	
Increased spending for PD and high-quality school materials	
Athletics program; coaches' stipends (\$84,400), transportation (\$50,000) and other expenses (\$11,894)	
Provide funds for Curtis Tufts graduation expenses	



Proposed New/Increased Spending to Base Budget

School-Based New/Increased Spending (continued)	
Band transportation to attend more competitions	
Increase Curriculum and Instruction software account to fully fund NWEA Map assessment application and fund the OA Dashboard for student performance management	
Deploy a more robust content protection platform on our network that includes classroom management functionality	



Proposed New/Increased Spending to Base Budget

Facilities/Technology New/Increased Spending	\$109,255
Add a fourth Carpenter/Maintenance Worker	budget neutral
Increase Contracted Maintenance line-items	
Increase the Equipment Repairs line-item	
Upgrade our cybersecurity package	



Total Savings to Current Base Budget

Reduce one teacher and para in the Brooks special needs program (from 5 classrooms to 4) due to lack of enrollment	
ELA Curriculum Payment, 3 rd of 3 payments made in FY2026	
Telephone and other Expenses	
Copier Lease	
NEASC accreditation expenses	
Miscellaneous line-item savings	
Savings Identified on April 6 to Current Base Budget	(\$490,991)
Additional Reductions (Already Included in This Budget Recommendation such as staffing reductions & changes to alternative revenue spending)	(\$575,500)
Total Savings to Current Base Budget	(\$1,066,491)



Overall Proposed Increase to Base Budget

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Overall Proposed Base Budget Increase	\$4,096,649



FY27 Preliminary Budget Recommendation

Changes to Appropriation & Stabilization Funds



FY27 Preliminary Budget Recommendation

FY2026 appropriation from general fund	\$85,490,000
FY2026 appropriation from stabilization fund	\$1,085,549
FY2026 total appropriation, base budget	\$86,575,549
Changes to base budget, funded with proposed appropriation increases and budget savings	\$4,096,649
FY2027 total appropriation, base budget	\$90,683,398
FY2027 appropriation from general fund	\$89,933,398
FY2027 appropriation from stabilization fund	\$750,000



Reconciliation with City's Budget Target

City's General Fund budget target	\$87,750,000
MPS FY2027 Preliminary Budget recommendation from general fund	\$89,933,398
Variance	\$2,083,398

Addressing the Budget Gap



In the absence of full funding, we will review:

- Staffing needed for FY2027 high school schedule
- Special Education paraprofessional staffing
- Revised new spending proposals
- Base budget for additional savings opportunities

Votes required to approve the FY2027 budget if the Preliminary Budget proposal is adopted:



- Approval of the FY2027 general fund appropriation of \$89,933,398
- Request that the Mayor and the City Council transfer \$750,000 allocated to the Medford Public Schools' stabilization fund to the School Department's FY2027 general fund appropriation.
- Request that the Mayor and the City Council appropriate a sum of \$530,500 from free cash for FY2027 capital and technology needs of Medford Public Schools to include the following:
 - Roberts School hot water tank replacement, \$250,000
 - Facilities conditions assessment identified repairs, \$75,000
 - Purchase and install interactive classroom panels, \$180,000
 - Replace aging defibrillators (AEDs), 25,500